

Hochan Bang 방호찬

M.S. Student · Biointelligence Lab
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M.S. student at **Seoul National University**, advised by **Prof. Byoung-Tak Zhang**. My research focuses on **Reinforcement Learning** and **Robotics**, with a particular interest in learning effective skill representations and dexterous hand manipulation. I aim to develop algorithms that enable embodied agents to master their own bodies and reveal the emergent intelligence that arises through interaction with their environment.

Publications

Discovering Compositional Primitives Invariant to Context Shift
Hochan Bang, Ganghun Lee, Min Whoo Lee, Minsu Lee, Byoung-Tak Zhang
NeurIPS 2026 Workshop PTA: From Pretrained Representations to Acting Agents, 2026

Deep Neural Networks as Finite-Step Hopfield Dynamics
Wooyul Jung, **Hochan Bang**, Hee Bin Yoo, Byoung-Tak Zhang
ICLR 2026 Workshop on New Frontiers in Associative Memories, 2026

Education & Experience

Education

2026.03 –	**M.S. Student, Seoul National University**, Computer Science and Engineering Advisor — Prof. Byoung-Tak Zhang
2019.03 – 2026.02	**B.S., Seoul National University**, Computer Science and Engineering (3.35/4.3 GPA)

Experience

2026 Spring	**Teaching Assistant**, "Artificial Intelligence (4190.408)", at CSE, SNU
2025 Winter	**SW Engineer Intern**, Tommoro Robotics
2025.04 – 2026.02	**Undergraduate Research Student**, Biointelligence Lab, SNU
2020.11 – 2022.05	**Military Service**, Republic of Korea Army

Research Projects * Led by me

Ongoing	MicroVLA (VLA with 12M parameters) · Distributionally robust multi-agent RL
Past	**Vision-based teleoperation for dexterous manipulation (Allegro+UR5)*** · Improving robustness to out-of-distribution observations for Diffusion-Transformer-based VLA · Imitation learning pipeline for a dexterous robot hand (with Hyundai)

Additional Information

Awards

2026.07	**Top Prize (Ministry of Trade, Industry and Energy, Korea)**, Humanoid Challenge 2026
2023.11	**2nd Prize**, SNU x Hansot 2nd Food Service Industry Startup Competition

Skills

Languages	Korean (native) · English (intermediate [TEPS 438])
Tools	Python · C# · C++ · Unity · Mujoco · Isaac Lab · ROS · OpenGL